1. What are included in Grave Model?

Monitoring and assessment and evaluation in the Language Curriculum Design model are included in one part of the Graves Model (2000) i.e. designing an assessment plan.

2. What are the weaknesses Murdoch's Model?

Principles, monitoring and assessment, and evaluation are not included in Murdoch's Model (2010). These are possible weaknesses of his model.

3. Describe waterfall model.

According to Tessmer and Wedman (1990) "waterfall" model, is where one stage of curriculum design (for example environment analysis) is done thoroughly and then the next stage of needs analysis is done thoroughly and so on. It is in the same way as the flow of water fills one container in a stepped-down series and then flows over to fill the next.

4. **What an existing bank of materials can include?**

(1) Copies of activities prepared by themselves or other teachers for other courses or for previous deliveries of the course (2) published supplementary materials such as graded readers, grammar activity books, conversation texts, speed reading courses and so on, (3) clippings from newspapers or magazines, recordings from the radio or TV or photocopied material from texts or course books. The curriculum designer or teacher chooses the bits and puts them together to make a course. The curriculum designer or teacher thus takes most responsibility for content, sequencing and goals.

5. What is Focused Opportunistic Approach?

In a focused opportunistic approach, the format and presentation part of the curriculum design process is typically done first. That is, material is gathered or prepared to teach the course. Then, with each re-teaching of the course, one part of the curriculum design process is done thoroughly. Thus, it might be that a proper needs analysis is not carried out until the third or fourth re-teaching of the course.

6. Describe three curriculum approaches.

Forward design starts with syllabus planning, moves to methodology, and is followed by assessment of learning outcomes. Resolving issues of syllabus content and sequencing are essential starting points with forward design, which has been the major tradition in language curriculum development.

Central design begins with classroom processes and methodology. Issues of syllabus and learning outcomes are not specified in detail in advance and are addressed as the curriculum is implemented. Many of the innovative methods of the 1980s and 90s reflect central design.

Backward design starts from a specification of learning outcomes and decisions on methodology and syllabus are developed from the learning outcomes.

7. Define Input, Process and the Curriculum.

In language teaching, ***input*** refers to the linguistic content of a course.

Process refers to how teaching is carried out and constitutes the domain of methodology in language teaching.

Curriculum can be both written and unwritten. Essentially, curriculum is what the school is attempting to teach, which might include social behaviors as well as content and thinking skills.

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8. Describe criteria for the selection of syllabus units.

Criteria for the selection of syllabus units include frequency, usefulness, simplicity, learnability and authenticity.

9. What is methodology?

Methodology encompasses the types of learning activities, procedures and techniques that are employed by teachers when they teach and the principles that underlie the design of the activities and exercises in their textbooks and teaching resources.

10. What is Forward Design?

Forward design is based on the assumption that input, process, and output are related in a linear fashion. In other words, before decisions about methodology and output are determined, issues related to the content of instruction need to be resolved. Curriculum design is seen to constitute a sequence of stages that occur in a fixed order – an approach that has been referred to as a 'waterfall' model (Tessmer and Wedman, 1990) where the output from one stage serves as the input to the stage that follows.

11. What is Corpus Analysis?

A linguistic approach to analyzing a **corpus** – a set of systematically or randomly collected and electronically stored 'real-life' language samples such as speeches, magazine articles, and texting messages – with a goal to discern certain rules of language use, grammatical or lexical patterns.

12. What is Discourse analysis?

It is a procedure that is used to study the nature of different text types, the ways they are used, and their lexical, grammatical, and textual features.

13. Write some examples of forward design methods.

The audio-lingual method, the audio-visual method and the structural situational method are some examples of forward design methods**.** More recent examples include Communicative Language Teaching (CLT) and content based teaching/CLIL.

14. Explain 'specialist approach'.

In some contexts the planning and development of each stage in the curriculum development process is carried out by different specialists who have expertise in each process, such as specialists in syllabus design, methodology and assessment. Graves (2008) describes this as a 'specialist approach'.

15. What is 'progressivism' according to Clark?

A progression from input, to process, to output and then to planning and delivery of instruction, it is only one route that can be taken. With central design, curriculum development starts with the selection of teaching activities, techniques and methods rather than with the elaboration of a detailed language syllabus or specification of learning outcomes. Issues related to input and output are dealt with after a methodology has been chosen or developed or during the process of teaching itself. Clark (1987) refers to this as 'progressivism' and an example of a process approach to the curriculum.

16. What is Backward Design?

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The third approach to curriculum design is to begin with a specification of learning outputs and to use these as the basis for developing instructional processes and input. Backward design starts with a careful statement of the desired results or outcomes: appropriate teaching activities and content are derived from the results of learning. It was sometimes described as an 'ends-means'.

17. What are the three steps recommended by Wiggins and McTighe in backward design?

They recommend the following three steps:

- Identify desired results.
- Determine acceptable evidence of learning.
- Plan learning experiences and instruction.

18. What is Needs Analysis?

Needs Analysis (identifying learning outcomes or objectives) is often seen to depend upon a systematic analysis of the learners' communicative needs. It emerged in the 1960s.

19. What is Informal needs assessment?

Informal needs assessment deals with the informal negotiation that takes place between class teachers and students in the form of chats with either individual students, groups of students or the whole class in order to select a focus for the class. It is a necessary component of information retrieval on students' learning needs and should be recorded. It can subsequently be used as input for aims and objective setting and for devising course outlines (Shaw and Dowsett, 1986).

20. What are the steps involved in informal needs assessment?

- Identify learner's communicative needs.
- Develop statements of learning objectives.
- Identify linguistic content and skills needed to attain the objectives.
- Prepare course plans.
- Select materials and teaching methods.

21. What is Competency-based Instruction within Backward Design Approach –I?

Competency-based Instruction (CpBI) is another widely used example of backward design. With CpBI the starting point of curriculum design is a specification of the learning outcomes in terms of 'competencies' – the knowledge, skills and behaviours learners involved in performing everyday tasks and activities and which learners should master at the end of a course of study.

22. What is the process of Competency-Based Instruction within Backward Design Approach II?

- Needs analysis.
- Identify topics for the survival curriculum (e.g. banking, health, shopping).
- Identify target tasks, design tasks.
- Identify competencies for each topic.
- Group competencies into instructional units.
- Identify the language knowledge and skills needed for each instructional unit (e.g. the 4 skills, vocabulary and grammar).
- Choose instructional materials.

23. What is Subject-centered Design?

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Subject-centered curriculum design revolves around a particular subject matter or discipline. For example, a subject-centered curriculum may focus on math or biology. In particular, this form of curriculum design is constructed without taking into account the specific learning styles of the students. The main goal and purpose is to standardize students, to make them alike with a "core curriculum.

24. What is Learner-centered Design according to Gibbons?

This approach places the learner at the center of the pedagogic process and sees education not as a matter of receiving information but of intelligent inquiry and thought (Gibbons, 2002).

25. What are the elements of learner-centered design?

A learner-centered curriculum will contain similar elements to those contained in traditional curriculum development, that is, planning (including needs analysis, goal and objective setting), implementation (including methodology and material development) and evaluation.

26. Describe Content Model: Classical Humanism in ELT Curriculum.

The central focus of the curriculum in this model is the content of what is to be learned by the learner. The content is knowledge and it is universal, unchanging and absolute. The purposes are to transmit knowledge of the language system and to make sure that students master grammar rules and vocabulary. The content of what is to be learned by or transmitted to the learner. The content is a valued cultural heritage, the understanding of which contributes to the overall intellectual development of the learner.

27. Describe Objectives Model: Reconstructionism in ELT Curriculum.

The starting point of this model of curriculum planning is no longer the content, but the objectives of the teaching learning program. The main purpose of education is to bring about some kind of social change. The influential curriculum designer E.W. Tyler promoted the use of behavioral objective (1930s). Mager (1962) gave the clearest definition of behavioral objectives: They have three elements: 1. Behavior 2, Conditions 3. Criterion

The attraction of the model is that it provides:

- Clarity of goals
- Ease of evaluation
- Accountability

28. Describe Process Model: Profressivism in ELT Curriculum.

Progresssivists believe that individuality, progress, and change are fundamental to one's education. Believing that people learn best from what they consider most relevant to their lives, progressivists center their curricula on the needs, experiences, interests, and abilities of students. Progressivist teachers try making school interesting and useful by planning lessons that provoke curiosity.

What are the central areas to the concept of communicative curriculum?

In the opinion of Dubin and Olshtain (1986), three areas are central to the concept of a communicative curriculum:

- Sociolinguistics

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- Cognitively based view of language learning
- Humanistic approach in education.

Q. Describe Tyler's Model.

Tyler's model for curriculum designing is based on the following questions:

- What educational purposes should the school seek to attain?
- What educational experiences can be provided that are likely to attain these purposes?
- How can these educational experiences be effectively organised?
- How can we determine whether these purposes are being attained?

Q. Describe Kerr's Model.

Most of the features in Kerr's model resemble those in Wheeler's and Tyler's models. However, Kerr divided the domains into four areas (Urevbu, 1985):

- Objectives
- Knowledge
- Evaluation,
- School learning experiences

Q. In Kerr's model, objectives are divided into how many groups?

- Affective
- Cognitive
- Psychomotor

Q. Describe Spiral Model.

In 1960s, Jerome Bruner put forward a theory of cognitive growth which looked to the influence of environmental and experiential factors in a child's education. It suggested that each child's intellectual ability develops in stages through changes in how the mind is used. Bruner's position was that young children need to learn the underlying principles of different concepts – the structure of ideas – rather than memorizing their related facts and data.

The spiral curriculum is predicated on cognitive theory advanced by Jerome Bruner (1960), who wrote "we begin with the hypothesis that any subject can be taught in some intellectually honest form to any child at any stage of development." In other words, even the most complex material, if properly structured and presented, can be understood by very young children. Bruner hypothesized that human cognition occurred in three relatively discreet stages: 1) Enactive, or actually manipulating and interacting with objects, 2) Iconic, or manipulating images of the objects or phenomena, and 3) Symbolic, or the manipulation of representations of the actual objects or phenomena.

Q. What are the key features of Bruner's work?

Key features of the spiral curriculum based on Bruner's work are:

- The student revisits a topic, theme or subject several times throughout their school career.

- The complexity of the topic or theme increases with each revisit.
- New learning has a relationship with old learning and is put in context with the old information

Q. What is Structural Syllabus?

The structural syllabus is based on a theory of language that assumes that the grammatical or structural aspects of language form are the most basic or useful. He further holds that a structural (or formal) syllabus is one in which the content of language teaching is a collection of the forms and structure (usually grammatical) of the language being taught.

Q. Describe rationales for the formal syllabus.

Breen (1987) sets forth three rationales:

- The first argument is that it is well established and it is informed by a long tradition of linguistic analysis.
- The second major justification for the formal syllabus is that it presents learners with a subject matter which is systematic and rule-governed. When we learn something new, we can begin to see patterns and regularities within it and that will reduce the 'learning load' it (i.e. new learning) demands of us.
- A third justification for the formal syllabus is that because the linguistic system is analysable in certain ways, these analytical categories or schemas can be incorporated in a plan for teaching the system, and further it may be that the same analytical categories or schemas make it easier for the learner to uncover how the new language works.

Q. What are the merits of structural syllabus?

Karanke (1987) mentions the positive characteristics of structural syllabus. Structure or grammar is the most general component of communicative competence.

- Its content is relatively easy to describe. Noun, verb, imperative, plural, and gerund are terms that are generally shared within the language profession, and there is general agreement about what they mean.
- Structural knowledge is the most measurable component of the communicative competence. Because of the relative fitness of structural knowledge and its relatively clear definition, measurement tasks are easily prepared to determine how much students have not learned.
- While structural knowledge does not seem to be used directly by learners, some evidence (Higgs & Clifford, 1982) suggests that it can prevent later fossilization or cessation of learning. Generally students who ultimately achieved high proficiency in a new language were students who had earlier received instruction in the form of the language.
- Instruction in language structure offers a basis for teachers or others to provide learners with feedback on the accuracy of their production.
- Structural syllabi are naturally valuable and culture-free.

Q. What are the drawbacks structural syllabuses?

Apparently the structural syllabus violates most, if not all, of the types of reward that should be catered for foreign language teaching materials as suggested by Stevick (1972) which can be summarized on the following grounds:

- Relevance of the content to the student's own language needs.
- Completeness or inclusion of all the language necessary for the stated aims.
- Authenticity of the materials both linguistically and culturally.

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- Satisfaction of the students with their day to day progress in the classroom.
- Immediacy of the usage of the students has learned in the classroom.

Q. Describe situational syllabus.

Palmer and Hornby (1937) believed that a grammatical or structural syllabus was neither efficient nor effective for language learning. Since this model offers language samples outside their social and cultural contexts, it makes transfer of learning from the classroom to the real world quite difficult.

Q. What are the types of situational syllabus?

Alexander (1976) differentiates three types of the situational syllabus based on type of information:

i. **Limbo Situation**: In this type, the information of the specific setting is of little importance, for example, the topic of introducing someone at the setting of a dialogue taking place at the stadium. It can be said that the setting is considered irrelevant, i.e. unimportant, because the main important thing is the language focus.

ii. **Concrete Situation**: The information is about the specific and concrete setting and the language associated with it, for example, the topic of ordering a meal at a restaurant.

iii. **Mythical Situation**: The information depends on fictional story line, frequently with a fictional cast characters in a fictional place.

Q. Describe functional/notional syllabus.

A functional-notional syllabus is based on learning to recognize and express the communicative functions of language and the concepts and ideas it expresses. In other words, this kind of syllabus is based more on the purposes for which language is used and on the meanings the speaker wanted to express than on the forms used to express them.

Q. Describe skill-based syllabus.

As Richards (2001) puts it, in a "skill-based syllabus", the content of the language teaching is a collection of specific abilities that may play a part in using language. Skill-based syllabi group linguistic competencies (pronunciation, vocabulary, grammar, and discourse) together into generalized types of behavior, such as listening to spoken language for the main idea, writing well-formed paragraphs, giving effective oral presentations, and so on. The primary purpose of skill-based instruction is to learn the specific language skill. A possible secondary purpose is to develop more general competence in the language learning.

Q. Describe content based syllabus.

Content-based instruction refers to an approach in which teaching is organized around the content rather than around a linguistic syllabus (Richards & Rodgers, 2001). Krahnke (1987) defines content-based syllabus as the teaching of content or information in the language being learned with little or no direct or explicit effort to teach the language itself separately from the content being taught.

Q. Describe task-based syllabus.

Nunan (2001) asserts that task-based syllabuses offer a specific realization of communicative language teaching and differs from the previously proposed syllabuses like structural, functional and notional syllabuses on the ground that task-based syllabuses start with needs analysis. This needs

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analysis results in a list of the target tasks that the learners need to carry out in real-life situations such as going through a job interview, completing a credit card application, and finding one's way from a hotel to a subway station.

Q. Define a task.

Skehan (2003) defines task as an activity in which: a) Meaning is primary. b) Learners are not given other peoples' meaning to repeat. c) There is some sort of relationship to comparable real world activities. d) Task completion has some sort of priority. e) The assessment of the task is in terms of outcome.

Q. What are the characteristics of a good task?

Nunan (1988) cites Candlin (1987) who mentions the characteristics of a good task, some of which have been listed below. A good task should:

- Promote attention to meaning, purpose, negotiation.
- Encourage attention to relevant data.
- Draw objectives from the communicative needs of learners.
- Define a problem to be worked through by learners, centered on the learners but guided by the teacher; and provide opportunities for meta-communication and meta-cognition (i.e. provide opportunities for learners to talk about communication and about learning).

Q. What is the psycholinguistic rationale for TBLT?

Raya quotes Ellis (2009) that the psycholinguistic rationale for Task-based Learning and Teaching (TBLT) is that:

- Learners have their own built-in syllabus which directs how they gradually learn the L2 systems.
- The primary goal of any form of language instruction is the development of implicit knowledge, without this learner will not be able to communicate effectively.
- Implicit knowledge can best be achieved by providing learners with opportunities to experience the L2 as a communicative tool.
- The resultant learning is incidental rather than intentional.

Q. Describe lexical and cultural syllabus.

Emergence of lexical syllabus was a reaction against traditional structural syllabus. The basic concept on which this syllabus rests is that students must be able to understand and use lexical phrases such as chunks, prefabricated patterns and collocations..

Q. What are criteria for the selection of lexical items?

i. Frequency

ii. Teachability

iii. Authenticity

iv. Coverage

v. Similarity

Q. List merits of a lexical syllabus.

Sinclair and Renouf (1988) list advantages of a lexical syllabus as follows:

- Practicality
- Efficiency
- Utility
- Authenticity
- Flexibility in implementation

Q. Describe cultural syllabus.

Brown (2007) maintains that, "A language is part of a culture and culture is part of language; the two are intricately interwoven so that one cannot separate the two without losing the significance of either language or culture".

Q. What are the benefits of cultural syllabus?

Fleet (2006) enumerates the benefits of a cultural syllabus as follows:

- It increases communicative competence.
- It allows more authentic language learning.
- It motivates learners to learn languages.
- It may affect their perceptions and attitudes toward the target language.

Q. What is negotiated syllabus?

A negotiated syllabus involves the teacher and the learners working together to make decisions at many levels of the curriculum design process. Negotiated syllabus is also called "process syllabus" (Breen, 1987). The word process in the term 'process syllabus' indicates that the important feature of this type of syllabus is that it focuses on how the syllabus is made rather than what should be in it.

Q. What are the requirements for a negotiated syllabus?

Breen (1987) describes the decisions to be negotiated in a negotiated (process) syllabus and the materials needed to make it work.

i. Negotiation procedure

ii. Course planning: participation

iii. Course planning: procedure

Q. What are the disadvantages of a negotiated syllabus?

i. The first is the result of a lack of knowledge or experience with such a syllabus.

ii. The second major disadvantage is that a fully negotiated syllabus requires considerable teacher skill and time in accessing and producing resources.

Q. Describe traditional unit structure.

- Presentation
- Controlled exploitation
- Free exploitation
- Synthesis

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Q. What are the approaches to sequence the activities in a language course?

Graham Low (2006) suggests two key approaches towards sequencing the activities in a course.

Writing-last solution: In it a unit normally ends with the writing task for the students. The emphasis of this approach is primarily on acquiring the grammatical items. There is a slight problem attached with this approach towards sequencing the activities in a course unit. If the unit ends with the writing task, then the importance of listening and speaking activity is ignored. The solution to this approach is multiple presentation designs which involve presenting the four strands of language learning that are reading, writing, listening and speaking.

Storyline solution: It creates a harmony throughout the unit while sequencing the activities in storyline situation. It is important to be aware of the elements of a story line; emotion and character so that students do not feel detached from it. The focus of this approach is on form and meaning of the language.

Q. What is coherence of course units?

Coherence is a systematic approach to aligning and sequencing specific ideas and the depth to which those ideas are examined, in order to help the development integrated understanding in learners.

Q. Define material design.

Material design is defined by Pardo and Tellez (2009) as: "It includes adaptation, creation of learning and teaching exercises; a task, an activity, a lesson, a unit or a module composed of several units."

Q. Define the terms 'input' and 'uptake'.

The term 'input' refers to the exposure of the language given to the students in the classroom through various sources, either written or spoken. On the other hand, uptake refers to posing question to the students in order to assess what they have learned and internalized through the activities taking place in the classroom.

Q. Define hidden curriculum.

Jackson (1986) refers a hidden curriculum to learning outcomes apart from those intended in the 'manifest curriculum'.

Q. What is the role of teacher in terms of evaluating language learning tasks?

A teacher has to play a vital role in terms of evaluating language learning tasks while implementing curriculum in the context of language classroom. Breen lists different roles of a teacher in which a language instructor has to look for these questions:

- To what extent was the task appropriate to learning objectives?
- To what extent was the content helpful?
- To what extent the chosen procedure proved to be appropriate?
- What knowledge was contributed to the task?
- What was familiar?
- What is discovered?
- What do we actually do while working on a task?
- What did we discover about each other's contributions during the task?
- What did we discover about the classroom and materials?

Q. Discuss theoretical framework.

Theoretical framework, as projected by Sterns, offers a remedy to the limited classroom research, going on the talk about curriculum implementation at classroom level. There are various variables involved which are part of this theoretical framework. The three independent levels of this framework are as follows:

- Theoretical concepts
- Policy directives
- Classroom behaviour

Q. How many categories of classroom implementation are there?

There are three categories of classroom implementation:

- Teaching strategies
- Timing strategies
- Social or interpersonal strategies

Q. Write down the characteristics of tests.

i. Reliability

ii. Validity

iii. Objectivity

iv. Usability

v. Norms

Q. What is placement assessment?

Placement assessment is used to decide what level of the course a learner should enter, what class the learner should join, and whether the learner should join the course at all. Placement assessment usually occurs under environment constraints. It often has to be done just before a course begins. The results have to be available quickly. The learners are largely unknown and may be confused about the course they wish to do.

Q. Describe short-term achievement assessment.

Short-term achievement assessment looks at the product of activities or a small set of activities. The purpose of this assessment is to see if the learners are making progress on a daily or weekly basis. It provides feedback to the teacher and the learners. In an intensive course a weekly test is a common way of carrying out this kind of assessment. In the test the learners are assessed on the work that they have done that week. Short-term assessment can also have motivational purposes, to make learners do required work and to give them feelings of achievement through success on the tests.

Q. What is performance objective?

A performance objective is a statement consisting of five parts (Brown, 1995):

- the subject
- the performance
- the conditions
- the measure
- the criterion

Q. Describe diagnostic assessment.

Diagnostic assessment is used to find the gaps and weaknesses in learners' knowledge so that something can be done about them. More positively, it is used to find what learners know well so that time is not wasted on teaching that. Diagnostic assessment is thus a very important part of needs analysis, both before a course begins and during the course. The findings of diagnostic assessment are used to determine what goes into a course. So good diagnostic assessment is accurate and easy to interpret in terms of what should be done as a result. Diagnostic information can often be obtained from assessment intended for other purposes, such as proficiency tests, achievement tests or placement tests. However, there are tests designed especially for diagnosis.

Q. Describe achievement assessment.

Achievement assessment measures both the achievement of learners during a course and the effectiveness of the course. Depending on the length of the course, there may be a final achievement test at the end, and perhaps one or two tests part of the way through a course. The tests part of the way through a course may have the purpose of picking up learners who are not achieving, so that something can be done to help them learn. These tests may also assess material that will not be assessed at the end of the course, thus allowing a greater spread of assessment of the material covered in the course.

Q. What are the characteristics of achievement test?

Achievement tests have the following characteristics:

- They are based on material taught in the course.
- Learners usually know what kinds of questions will be asked and what material will be covered.
- They are criterion referenced.

Q. Describe proficiency assessment.

A test of language proficiency draws items for the test not from the course that the learners are studying, but from the language itself independent of any course. The reason for this is that the purpose of a proficiency test is to show how much the learners know of the language or a particular part of the language. If the selection of language items and skills to go in a course has been based upon a valid analysis of the language then there may not be a big difference between what is in a proficiency test and an achievement test, except perhaps that the proficiency test is likely to cover a larger range of items and skills.

Q. Describe criteria for good Assessment.

Reliability: A reliable test gives results that are not greatly upset by conditions that the test is not intended to measure. After allowing for the practice effect, if the same person sat the test twice, they should get near enough to the same result. Statistically reliability is measured by having the learners sit the test twice, or more commonly, by splitting the scores on the individual test items into two equal groups and seeing if the learners get the same score on both groups.

Validity: A valid test measures what it is supposed to measure. A valid achievement test measures what has been learned on the course. A valid listening test measures skill at listening. The most practical ways for a teacher or curriculum designer to check the validity of a test are to look at its face validity and content validity.

Practicality: Not only a test must be reliable and valid, it must also be practical.

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Q. What is an Evaluation?

The process of determining, to what extent the educational objectives are actually being realized. The broadest kind of evaluation looks at all aspects of curriculum design to see if the course is the best possible course to implement. Evaluation requires looking at both the results of the course, and the planning and running of the course.

Q. Discuss accountability.

Accountability refers to the extent to which those involved in a program are answerable for the quality of their work. Accountability-oriented evaluation usually examines the effects of a program or project at significant end points of an educational cycle and is usually conducted for the benefit of an external audience or decision maker.

Q. Discuss development-oriented evaluation.

Development-oriented evaluation is designed to improve the quality of a program as it is being implemented. It may involve staffs who are involved in the program as well as others who are not and may have a teacher-development focus (Weir and Roberts 1994).

The different purposes for evaluation are referred to us: formative, illuminative, and summative evaluation.

Kiely and Rea-Dickens (2006) make a useful three-way scope distinction:

(1) large-scale evaluations (2) teacher-led evaluations, and (3) management-led evaluations..

Topic-216: Gathering the Information

The tools of needs analysis and the tools of evaluation are somewhat similar to each other. The purposes, for which the tools are used, differ and in an evaluation they are used to gather a much wider range of data. Let us now look at a few of the most useful information-gathering tools in more detail. This can involve looking at the performance of teachers and learners, observing lessons and examining achievement. Evaluation can also look at the environment of the course, which may involve looking at administrative procedures, availability and quality of resources, and how outsiders view the course.

Illuminative Evaluation

This refers to evaluation that seeks to find out how different aspects of the program work or are being implemented. It seeks to provide a deeper understanding of the processes of teaching and learning that occur in the program, without necessarily seeking to change the course in any way as a result.

Summative Evaluation

Summative evaluation is concerned with determining the effectiveness of a program, its efficiency, and to some extent with its acceptability. It takes place after a program has been implemented.

There are many approaches for language program evaluation:

- **Product oriented:** This approach focuses on the goals and objectives of a curriculum that match with the instruction objectives.
- **Process oriented:** It deals with the LCD change, innovation and improvement in implementing the curriculum.

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- **Static characteristic:** It deals with looking at the perspective of external agency. It looks at the institute in terms of its overall standing and ranking.
- **Decision facilitation:** It is a cyclic process that continuously gathers information about needs, environment and situation analysis.

Language Program Evaluation: Dimensions

There are three dimensions of a language program evaluation.

- Formative vs summative
- Process vs product
- Quantitative vs qualitative

Steps in Introducing Change

1. Make sure that the change is really needed:
2. Plan the type of change so that it is not too great and not too small (Stoller, 1994):
3. Make sure that enough people see that the kind of change is possible:
4. Use a wide range of change strategies:
5. Be prepared for the change to take a long time:

Realistic Change

Change may start from dissatisfaction with the present situation. If it does, it must also be obvious to those involved that the proposed change is possible and will be an improvement. That it will involve more gains than losses.

Using a Variety of Change Strategies

Kennedy (1987) describes three major approaches to change:

- Power–coercive, where change is achieved through authority, rules and top-down pressure.
- Rational–empirical, where change is achieved through explaining, justifying and showing the reasons why the change is good and necessary.
- Normative–re-educative, where change is achieved through discussion, involvement and negotiation. In the short term, power–coercive involves less time than rational–empirical which involves less time than normative–re-educative.

Features of an Effective Workshop

An effective workshop has clear goals, and involves new content, and its presentation encourages the involvement of the participants.

Goals

In general, workshops can have one or more of the following five goals:

- Understanding and remembering new ideas
- Experiencing and evaluating exercises
- Producing material or exercises,
- Planning units of work,
- Problem solving

Content

Workshops need to involve the input of new information, otherwise there is a danger that they will result in unproductive discussion. When planning a workshop it is important to plan where this new information will come from. Here are some possible sources:

- Pre-reading of articles and notes distributed several days before the workshop.
- Prepared talks by the workshop organiser, an invited speaker or selected participants.
- Prepared model activities either on video, demonstrated live or in written form.
- Spontaneous discussion involving informed participants.
- Feedback by an informed participant.

Presentation

For a workshop to be successful, participants need to be interested and active. Ideally a workshop should provide a learning experience that could not be gained by working alone. Involvement can be encouraged if there is a clear task to do with a clear, well-described outcome which the participants see as important and valuable for them. Group work can be effective, but often participants are more interested in gaining input from a visiting speaker than in gaining input from their colleagues. If a visiting speaker is the main source of input, it is possible to do small amounts of group work with feedback during the presentation.

Lamb found the following range of effects on the participants a year after the workshop:

- No uptake
- Confusion
- Mislabelling
- Appropriation
- Assimilation
- Adaptation and rejection
- Engagement

The input data (the content) of the understanding component of a workshop can come in several forms:

- Talks and lectures
- Set reading
- Discussions

Evaluating Workshops

Once a workshop has been planned, and again after it has ended, it is worth reflecting on its planning to see if improvements are possible. Workshops may also be assessed by using the parts of the curriculum design diagram by looking at needs and whether they were met, whether environmental constraints were considered, whether sensible principles were followed, and so on.

Strengths and Challenges in Integrating Internet-Based Materials

Does the design of your reading lesson justify the use of its medium, that is, do the learning tasks take full advantage of the potential of the medium?

Are the reading materials and learning tasks appropriate for the students' level of proficiency?

Do the activities engage the learners in real-world and meaningful tasks as well as in a variety of skills (e.g., communicative, reading, cultural explorations, and writing)?

How do students demonstrate what they have learned?

Are all the instructions clearly stated?

Are all the hyperlinks functional?

Advantages of Electronic Medium Over Print

In recent years, it is observed that internet has more advantages over print medium. Internet based language learning (IBLL) is one of the most innovative domains in English language teaching. Electronic books can be useful and handy in terms of language learning. Internet based language learning can engage students in various ways where they can improve their communication via emails and writing blogs. It promotes language learning autonomy among students and transforms passive learning into active learning. E-materials help students to involve into more engaged learning experience.

The NCEL under the category of "Reading and Thinking Skills" gives two standards, and each standard is explained through benchmarking and further illustrated through specific examples to measure the targeted skills.

Standard 1

All students will search for, discover and understand a variety of text types through tasks which require multiple reading and thinking strategies for comprehension, fluency and enjoyment.

Benchmark I: Evaluate patterns of text organization, and function of various devices used within and beyond a paragraph in a text.

Benchmark II: Analyze, synthesize and evaluate events, issues, ideas and viewpoints, applying reading comprehension and thinking strategies.

Benchmark III: Analyze and synthesize information from a visual cue or a graphic organizer to summarize while highlighting the key areas and main trends.

Benchmark IV: Gather, analyze, evaluate and synthesize information to use for variety of purposes including a research project using various aids and study skills.

Standard 2

All students will read and analyze literary text to seek information, ideas, enjoyment, and to relate their own experiences to those of common humanity as depicted in literature.

Benchmark I: Analyze and evaluate short stories, poems, essays and one-act plays; relate how texts affect their lives and connect the texts to contemporary / historical ideas and issues across cultures.

Needs Analysis

One of the most common problems in teaching is suiting the activities and material in lessons to a class with a wide range of proficiency. Every day teachers have to consider questions like the following:

- Is this material too difficult for my learners?
- Is there something new for my learners to learn in this activity?
- Will everyone in the class be able to cope with this activity?